



DEPARTMENT CIRCULAR NO. HRA-003
Series of 2025

JUL 28 2025

**SUBJECT : PRESCRIBING INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATION FOR
STANDARDIZATION (ISO) STANDARDS ON INFORMATION
SECURITY FOR ENTITIES ENGAGED IN THE
TELECOMMUNICATIONS BUSINESS**

WHEREAS, Republic Act No. 10844 or the Department of Information and Communications Technology Act of 2015 mandates the Department of Information and Communications Technology (DICT) to plan, develop, and promote the national Information and Communications Technology (ICT) agenda;¹

WHEREAS, Section 6 of R.A. No. 10844 states that the DICT shall formulate, recommend, and implement national policies, plans, programs, and guidelines that will promote the development and use of ICT with due consideration to the advantages of convergence and emerging technologies;²

WHEREAS, Section 8 of R.A. No. 10844 states that the DICT shall formulate such rules and regulations and exercise such other powers as may be required to implement the objectives of R.A. No. 10844;³

WHEREAS, Section 26 of R.A. No. 11659 requires entities engaged in the telecommunication business to obtain and maintain certifications from an accredited certification body attesting to their compliance with International Organization for Standardization (ISO) standards, and that such certifications shall be a continuing qualification for retention of franchise or other authority to operate;⁴

WHEREAS, the same Section directs the DICT to prescribe relevant ISO standards on information security that entities engaged in the telecommunications business must comply with;⁵

WHEREAS, Section 1 of R.A. No. 11659, or An Act Amending Commonwealth Act No. 146, Otherwise known as the Public Service Act, As Amended, declares that the State shall encourage private enterprises and expands the base of investment in the country, with the goal of providing efficient, reliable, and affordable basic services to all;⁶

¹ An Act Creating the Department of Information and Communications Technology, Defining its Powers and Functions Appropriating Funds Therefor, And For Other Purposes [Department of Information and Communications Technology Act of 2015], Republic Act No. 10844 § 5 (2016).

² *Id.* § 6.

³ *Id.* § 8.

⁴ *Id.* § 26.

⁵ *Id.*

⁶ An Act Amending Commonwealth Act No. 146, Otherwise known as the Public Service Act, As Amended [Public Service Act], Republic Act No. 11659 § 1 (2022).



WHEREAS, Section 47 of the Implementing Rules and Regulations (IRR) of RA No. 11659 mandates entities engaged in the telecommunications business to obtain and maintain certifications from an accredited certification body attesting to compliance with relevant ISO standards on information security as prescribed by the DICT;⁷

WHEREAS, Section 2 of R.A. No. 11934 or the Subscriber Identity Module (SIM) Registration Act recognizes the vital role of information and communications technology in nation-building and encourages its growth and development, while also acknowledging that, as beneficial as modern technology is, its illegal or malicious use endangers lives, damages property, poses risks to public order, and threatens national security;⁸

WHEREAS, Section 6 of R.A. No. 11934 requires Public Telecommunications Entities (PTE) to comply with the minimum information security standards prescribed by the DICT consistent with internationally accepted cybersecurity standards and relevant laws, rules, and regulations;⁹

WHEREAS, Section 10 (I) of the IRR of R.A. No. 11934 obligates PTEs to ensure that end-users' data are secured, encrypted, and protected at all times and compliant with the minimum information security standards prescribed by the DICT;¹⁰

WHEREFORE, in consideration of the foregoing premises, and without prejudice to the application of other pertinent laws, rules, and regulations on the matter, the DICT hereby issues this Department Circular prescribing the ISO standards on information security for entities engaged in the telecommunications business:

Section 1. Scope. This Department Circular shall cover natural and juridical persons engaged in the telecommunication business. It shall exclude micro, small, and medium enterprises (MSMEs) classified under R.A. No. 6977 or the Magna Carta for Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises, as amended.

Section 2. Purpose. The DICT prescribes the relevant ISO standards on information security pursuant to Section 26 of R.A. No. 11659 and Section 6 of R.A. No. 11934.

Section 3. ISO Information Security Standards. Covered entities shall refer to the Philippine National Standards (PNS) ISO/IEC 27000 - Information Security Management family of standards. Relevant and applicable standards under PNS ISO/IEC 27000 are

⁷ National Economic and Development Authority, Department of Energy, Department of Environment and Natural Resources, Department of Information and Communications Technology, Department of Transportation, Civil Aeronautics Board, Civil Aviation Authority of the Philippines, Energy Regulatory Commission, Land Transportation Franchising and Regulatory Board, Land Transportation Office, Local Water Utilities Administration, Maritime Industry Authority, Metropolitan Waterworks and Sewerage System, National Telecommunications Commission, National Water Resources Board, Philippine National Railways, Philippine Ports Authority, Toll Regulatory Board, Implementing Rules and Regulations of the Republic Act No. 11659 or An Act Amending Commonwealth Act No. 146, Otherwise known as the Public Service Act, As Amended [IRR of R.A. No. 11659] § 47 (2023).

⁸ An Act Requiring the Registration of Subscriber Identity Module [SIM Registration Act], Republic Act No. 11934 § 2 (2022).

⁹ *Id.* § 6.

¹⁰ National Telecommunications Commission, Rules and Regulations Implementing Republic Act No. 11934, Otherwise Known as the "Subscriber Identity Module (SIM) Registration Act" [IRR Republic Act No. 11934] NTC Memorandum Circular No. 001-12-2022 § 10 (I) (2022).



available in Annex A.

Section 4. Information Security Standards Certification. Covered entities shall obtain the relevant and applicable information security standards certification from a certification body accredited by the Philippine Accreditation Bureau of the Department of Trade and Industry.

Section 5. Maintenance; Effect. The maintenance of the relevant and applicable information security standards certification shall be a continuing qualification for the retention of franchise or the authority to operate issued by the National Telecommunications Commission (NTC).

Section 6. Transitory Period. Covered entities shall fully comply with the relevant and applicable information security standards certification within three (3) years from the effectivity of this Circular.

Section 7. NTC Guidelines on Compliance. Upon the effectivity of this Department Circular, the NTC shall issue corresponding guidelines on the compliance and maintenance of the relevant and applicable information security standards certification.

Section 8. Separability. If any section or provision of this Department Circular is declared null and void, or unconstitutional, the other provisions not affected thereby shall continue to be in force and effect.

Section 9. Repealing Clause. All rules, regulations, and issuances contrary to or inconsistent with the provisions of this Department Circular are deemed repealed or modified accordingly.

Section 10. Effectivity Clause. This Department Circular shall take effect immediately after its publication in the Official Gazette and any newspaper of general circulation and upon filing with the Office of the National Administrative Register of the University of the Philippines Law Center.


HENRY R. AGUDA
Secretary

Copy furnished:

All concerned.

**PRESCRIBING INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATION FOR STANDARDIZATION (ISO) STANDARDS
ON INFORMATION SECURITY FOR ENTITIES ENGAGED IN THE TELECOMMUNICATIONS BUSINESS**





ANNEX A RELEVANT AND APPLICABLE ISO INFORMATION SECURITY STANDARDS

Covered entities shall use the most recent standards within the Philippine National Standard ISO/IEC 27000. These include, but are not limited to:

1. **PNS ISO/IEC 27000** - Information technology - Security techniques - Information security management systems - Overview and vocabulary;¹¹
2. **PNS ISO/IEC 27001** - Information Security, Cybersecurity, and Privacy Protection — Information Security Management Systems Requirements;¹²
3. **PNS ISO/IEC 27002** - Information security, cybersecurity, and privacy protection - Information security controls;¹³
4. **PNS ISO/IEC 27011** - Information security, cybersecurity, and privacy protection — Information security controls based on ISO/IEC 27002 for telecommunications organizations;¹⁴
5. **PNS ISO/IEC 27031** - Information Technology — Security Techniques — Guidelines for information and communication Technology readiness for business continuity;¹⁵
6. **PNS ISO/IEC 27035-1** - Information Technology — Information Security Incident Management — Part 1: Principles and process;¹⁶
7. **PNS ISO/IEC 27035-2** - Information Technology — Information Security Incident Management — Part 2: Guidelines to plan and prepare for incident response;¹⁷
8. **PNS ISO/IEC 27035-3** - Information Technology — Information Security Incident Management — Part 3: Guidelines for ICT incident response operations;¹⁸ and
9. **PNS ISO/IEC 29134** - Guidelines for privacy impact assessment.¹⁹

ANNEX A: RELEVANT AND APPLICABLE ISO INFORMATION SECURITY STANDARDS

Dated: JUL 28 2025

¹¹ PNS ISO/IEC 27000, available at <https://standardsph.dti.gov.ph/portal/catalogue/ISOIEC27000>

¹² PNS ISO/IEC 27001, available at <https://standardsph.dti.gov.ph/portal/catalogue/ISOIEC27001>

¹³ PNS ISO/IEC 27002, available at <https://standardsph.dti.gov.ph/portal/catalogue/ISOIEC27002>

¹⁴ PNS ISO/IEC 27011, available at <https://standardsph.dti.gov.ph/portal/catalogue/ISOIEC27011>

¹⁵ PNS ISO/IEC 27031, available at <https://standardsph.dti.gov.ph/portal/catalogue/ISOIEC27031>

¹⁶ PNS ISO/IEC 27035-1, available at <https://standardsph.dti.gov.ph/portal/catalogue/ISOIEC27035-1>

¹⁷ PNS ISO/IEC 27035-2, available at <https://standardsph.dti.gov.ph/portal/catalogue/ISOIEC27035-2>

¹⁸ PNS ISO/IEC 27035-3, available at <https://standardsph.dti.gov.ph/portal/catalogue/ISOIEC27035-3>

¹⁹ PNS ISO/IEC 29134, available at <https://standardsph.dti.gov.ph/portal/catalogue/ISOIEC29134>

